# Preface

There comes a time in life when there is an inner voice urging you to write about your experiences, and chart the course of your life, with all its ups and downs. One day in November 2007, when my second innings in life was just beginning, Patwant Singh said he would like to help me write my memoirs. I thanked him but said I needed some more time. Alas, unluckily for me, that was not meant to be, for Patwant passed away soon thereafter.

At that point in time, some publishing houses had also expressed an interest in publishing my story – even if it meant waiting for a few years. Further, my family, some fellow officers and friends, including media persons, kept asking me 'when' or 'if' I was coming out with my book.

Therefore, I decided to pen down my thoughts before my memory started to fade and the whole exercise became futile! What this book contains are my *personal views*. The constitutional position held by me has to some extent prevented me from writing about certain sensitive issues or writing more freely about some others. Frankly, I did face a moral dilemma while undertaking this project. Should I describe my achievements objectively, even if they might appear as self-praise, or take the mellow approach. My decision was to write about events as they happened and while doing so, be as factually correct as possible.

Perhaps I had more than my fair share of 'field' or operational-area assignments. As a result, the conflict in my mind between duty and family was often palpable. However, not once did I ask anyone to exert an influence on the course of my career. Going through this journey on my own terms, taking the good and bad bounces, as